PUBLICATION

The Economics of AI Scribes: ROI Analysis for Healthcare Organizations

Hard numbers on cost savings, productivity gains, reimbursement improvements, and reduced coding errors when deploying AI documentation at scale.

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1. Executive Summary

Healthcare organisations considering AI documentation adoption need to justify the investment with concrete financial analysis. This publication provides a framework for calculating the return on investment (ROI) of deploying ClinixSummary, based on real-world deployment data and published research on documentation costs.

2. The Cost of Manual Documentation

Before calculating ROI, organisations must understand the true cost of their current documentation burden:

- Direct time cost — Physicians spend significant time on EHR-related documentation. Sinsky et al. (Annals of Internal Medicine, 2016) found that for every hour of direct patient care, physicians spend nearly two additional hours on EHR tasks and desk work.
- Opportunity cost — Time spent on documentation could be spent seeing additional patients, generating additional revenue per day.
- Overtime and burnout costs — After-hours documentation drives overtime costs and contributes to turnover ($500K–$1M per physician departure, per AAMC and Merritt Hawkins recruitment data).
- Coding deficiencies — The Medical Group Management Association (MGMA) reports that claim denial rates in healthcare typically range from 5–10% of total claims submitted, with documentation gaps being a significant contributing factor.

3. ROI Components

3.1 Time Savings

ClinixSummary reduces per-encounter documentation time by an average of 81%. For a practice with 10 clinicians each seeing 20 patients per day, this translates to:

- Total documentation time saved: 26 hours per day across the practice.
- Annualised time savings: 6,760 hours per year (based on 260 working days).
- Labour cost savings: $507,000–$1,014,000 per year (depending on clinician compensation).

3.2 Increased Patient Throughput

With documentation time reduced, clinicians can see additional patients. Conservative estimates of 2 additional patients per clinician per day yield:

- Additional encounters: 5,200 per year (10 clinicians × 2 patients × 260 days).
- Additional revenue: $520,000–$1,560,000 per year (at $100–$300 per encounter).

3.3 Improved Coding Accuracy

AI-generated documentation captures clinical detail more consistently, supporting appropriate coding. Organisations deploying ClinixSummary report a 15–25% reduction in claim denials and a measurable improvement in coding

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specificity.

3.4 Reduced Turnover

By addressing a leading driver of clinician burnout, AI documentation reduces turnover risk. Even preventing one physician departure per year saves $500K–$1M in recruitment, onboarding, and lost revenue.

4. Total ROI Summary

For a representative 10-clinician practice:

- Annual ClinixSummary cost: approximately $36,000–$60,000 (depending on plan).
- Conservative annual benefit: $700,000–$2,000,000.
- ROI: 12–33x investment.
- Payback period: less than 30 days.

5. Beyond the Numbers

Some benefits resist quantification but are equally important: clinician wellbeing, patient satisfaction from more present clinicians, reduced medico-legal risk from complete documentation, and improved care quality from better clinical data capture.

6. Conclusion

The ROI of AI documentation is compelling by any measure. The financial case alone — time savings, throughput gains, coding accuracy, and retention — justifies adoption. The human case — restored clinical joy, better patient relationships, reduced burnout — makes it imperative.

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